

3.5.3 The purpose and methods of market research

Content	Additional information
Purpose of market research Collect information about: • demand • competition • target market.	Students should understand why businesses conduct market research, such as to identify market opportunities and to get a better insight into their customers and competitors.
Methods of market research to include primary and secondary: • questionnaires • surveys • interviews • focus groups • internet research • printed press eg newspapers.	Students should understand the difference between qualitative and quantitative market research. Students should identify the benefits and drawbacks for various market research techniques and select the best method for a given business.

Content	Additional information
Use of market research: information that may help decision making	Students should be able to interpret and use qualitative and quantitative market research findings to help make appropriate decisions for different types of business. Students should be expected to manipulate and interpret data from tables and charts. Students should be able to identify market size and market share.